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PER CENT FROM KOLKATA AND 27 PER CENT FROM BANGALORE WOULD LIKE TO TRY BONDAGE SEX AS AGAINST 14 PER CENT FROM ALL OVER INDIA.

answered in the negative to the same question, 27 per cent said they harboured the stranger fantasy. If we look at particular cities, 40 per cent of women in Delhi and 21 per cent in Ludhiana responded that they had actually 'done' the stranger role during sex. Curiously enough, only 16 per cent of male respondents from both Delhi and Ludhiana said that they had played out the stranger role. There are three (or, at least three) things we might speculate on in this context. First, that while our social norms insist that we should marry those whose backgrounds are familiar (in terms of class and caste, say), there is now greater openness towards admitting that erotic lives are not dictated by social rules and regulations. Second, this may also indicate greater willingness to articulate the difficult nature of intimate relationships such as marriage. If this is at all true, then we may be able to draw some (cautious) conclusions about the emergence of a more critical attitude towards taken-for-granted notions of love and marriage. Finally, if we look at the numbers for Delhi and Ludhiana, for example, there are indications that a larger number of women (than at earlier times, and, in comparison to men in these cities) like to think about pleasure when thinking about sex. The extraordinarily explicit discussions on female sexuality in various mainstream Hindi women's magazines currently in circulation perhaps provide a clue that the figure of the asexual Mother India may be somewhat in decline, giving way to the traditional modernity of, say, the *swayamvar* mode Rakhi Sawant.

The notion of traditional modernity allows us to think about the seeming contradictions in the several of the responses. So, for example, how do we reconcile the fact that while more women like to think about role playing (as a way of enhancing sexual pleasure, one assumes), a surprisingly large number of those surveyed—30 per cent in Bangalore, 23 per cent in Ludhiana, and 10 per cent in Mumbai—admitted that they fantasised about being raped by their partners as role-play. Further, 30 per cent of women from Bangalore said that they had actually played out the rape fantasy, whereas the figures for Ludhiana and Mumbai were 29 per cent and 5 per cent respectively. Perhaps, the women of Mumbai had second thoughts, but those from Bangalore and Ludhiana did not. Do masculine fantasies of power—the kinds that characterise the much-hyped Savita Bhabhi comic character—continue to play a role in the lives of women? There is a further complicating factor that needs to be addressed in future surveys. For, not only did women respond to the question regarding being raped, but also to another that asked about the fantasy of raping their partner: were they necessarily thinking about heterosexual relationships? In either case, the responses



are unsettling, to say the least. Further, what should also give us pause for thought is the number of men who fantasised about raping their partners: 29 per cent overall, with 56 per cent in Bangalore, 33 per cent in Mumbai and 29 per cent in Hyderabad. Is there a national fantasy of rape that is shared fairly equally by men and women? And, does this have anything to do with the (albeit slow) changes in the position of women, that, in turn, attracts backlash from established relations of power? Or, is it that power is, literally, an aphrodisiac and hence plays an important role in the making of erotic cultures? Finally, notwithstanding all this, it is an odd thing that the much-trumpeted face of India's globalisation, Bangalore, should register the most consistently high figures for the rape fantasy.

A remarkably small number of women across all cities has either thought of, or had tried, sex toys during their intimate moments: 9 per cent and 5 per cent respectively. Perhaps predictably, the most responses for both categories (thought of/tried) came from cities where the female population might have the greatest access to the toys: Mumbai and Hyderabad. Though, and this is significant, the number of women who said that they would like to try sex